

Problem No. 1 (5 Points):

Solution:

These Norwegian words consist of 2 components: *far* and *mor*. We can assume that Norwegian has different words for grandparents who are mother's parents (mother's mother and mother's father) and for grandparents who are father's parents (father's mother and father's father). In this case we can guess that the components *far* and *mor* mean 'mother' and 'father' (the order is yet unknown).

It's obvious that the word *farmor* means father's mother (it means 'grandmother' and consists of 2 different components), but what about the meaning of the other words?

We can find out the meaning of the words *far* and *mor* comparing them to the words with the same meaning in other European languages. English *father*, German *Vater* or French *père* mean 'father', English *mother*, German *Mutter* and French *mère* mean 'mother', so it's natural to assume that the word *far* means 'father', and the word *mor* means 'mother'.

Then the structure of the Norwegian words in question is as follows:

far-mor = father's mother ('grandmother who is my father's mother')

far-far = father's father ('grandfather who is my father's father')

mor-mor = mother's mother ('grandmother who is my mother's mother')

mor-far = mother's father ('grandfather who is my mother's father')

- Yu. Kuznetsova
